

The Professor's twisted logic fits modern banking theory nicely. There is a knock on the door, and the Professor shouts, "Come in!"

"Only the tailor, Sir, with your little bill," said a meek voice outside the door.

"Ah, well, I can soon settle *his* business," the Professor said to the children, "if you'll just wait a minute. How much is it, this year, my man?" The tailor had come in while he was speaking.

"Well, it's been doubling so many years, you see," the tailor replied, a little gruffly, "and I think I'd like to see the money now. It's two thousand pounds, it is!"

"Oh, that's nothing!" the Professor carelessly remarked, feeling in his pocket, as if he always carried at least that amount about with him. "But wouldn't you like to wait just another year, and make it *four* thousand? Just think how rich you'd be! Why, you might be a *King*, if you liked!"

"I don't know as I'd care about being a *King*," the man said thoughtfully, "but it *dew* sound a powerful sight o' money! Well, I think I'll wait—"

"Of course you will!" said the Professor. "There's good sense in you, I see. Good-day to you, my man!"

"Will you ever have to pay him that four thousand pounds?" Sylvie asked as the door closed on the departing creditor.

"*Never*, my child!" the Professor replied emphatically. "He'll go on doubling it, til he dies. You see, it's always worth while waiting another year, to get twice as much money!"

Carroll's book was published in 1889, and since death does not occur in this fantasy world, I assume that the Professor and the tailor kept up their annual rollover exercise, which means that the tailor's "little bill" is now valued in uncountable trillions of dollars. And it continues to double every year, which means that this little un-